thames view



ISSUE 4

YOUR COMMUNITY MAGAZINE

MAY 05



This summer's Trust Thamesmead Festival is shaping up to be a good one with community acts and celebrity entertainment keeping everyone entertained. Part of the festival is taking a look at how Thamesmead has changed over the decades and what it might look like in the future and we would like your help in bringing together a film presentation. Do you have home movies of historical scenes or landmark events in Thamesmead? Or photos, drawings and artifacts illustrating an interesting story?

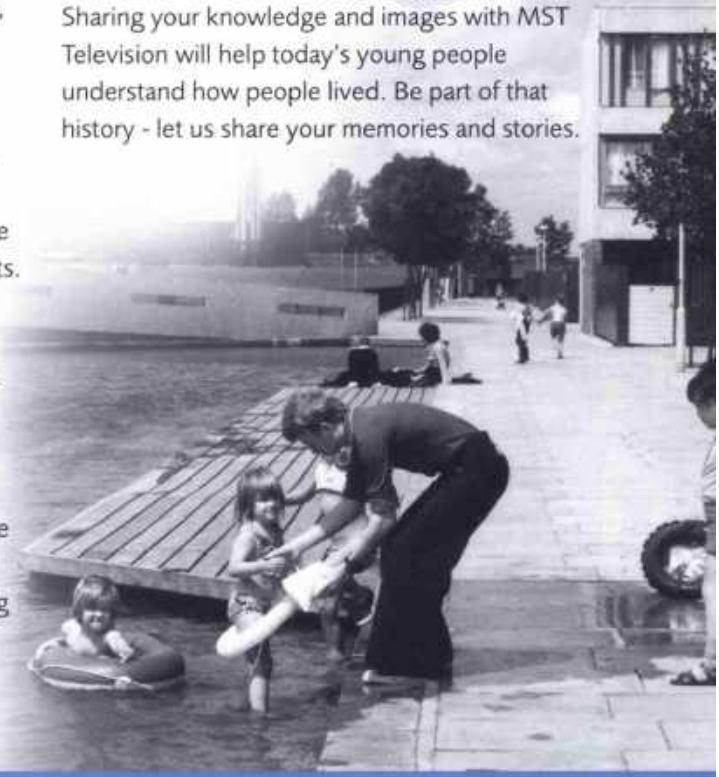
MST Television is making a video of the history of Thamesmead, starting at 1878 when the Princess Alice sank off Gallions Reach right up to the present day. They are particularly interested in seeing changes to the landscape, the riverscape and community developments.

So if you have any stories about famous or infamous characters who lived in the area, or about major events that have taken place why not get in touch with MST Television. They are really interested to hear about the effects on the community and the area during the two World Wars or what the community did to celebrate the Queen's accession to the throne and her Silver and Golden Jubilees? The television company is also looking for an insight into how life was in and around the area between 1900 and 1960.

So if you have any memories or material which maybe of interest, please write to: Head of Research, History of Thamesmead, c/o MST Television, 5a Cuthbert Street, London W2 1XT or send an email to info@msttelevision.co.uk.

Please do not send any pictures or material at this stage. We would just like your stories and then will contact you for further material at a later date, as the cost of postage for any item used will be met by us. Please note that fees or royalties will not be paid and you will need to sign a proof-of-ownership and right-of-use document.

Sharing your knowledge and images with MST Television will help today's young people understand how people lived. Be part of that history - let us share your memories and stories.



TAVY BRIDGE TIMELINE
Keeping up to date with the latest news

FOOTBALL CRAZY
Catch up with kids who can kick it

ONE TO ONE
The faces behind Thamesview

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION

Tavy Bridge Timeline

The regeneration of Tavy Bridge has been characterised by resident consultation. At every stage we have sought to take on board the comments and concerns of those who live in Tavy Bridge. The Tavy Bridge Residents Action Group is being launched to allow residents input into every aspect of the regeneration project, including some of the design features in the new look Tavy Bridge. One of the key features in the architect's plans is to incorporate semi private, first floor landscaped terraces with car parking underneath. This is a new concept and the residents were invited to view a new development in Southampton where this is a central design element.

Admirals Quay in Southampton was designed by Broadway Malyan, the same architects working on the Tavy Bridge plans. After an early start one Saturday morning the group arrived in Southampton and were shown around the development by staff of the schemes marketing department. First impressions were positive and the group was particularly impressed with the first floor terraces. The group liked certain elements of the layout of the apartments, in particular the bathrooms, living area and kitchen as well as the block security and the foyer. The visit also raised some concerns that the group will be taking to the designers.

The Residents Action Group spent nearly two hours taking in the selection of apartments and getting a good impression of how their new homes might look. All agreed that the experience was an excellent way to see first hand what they liked about their current homes and what they would like to see in their new ones.

Sheila Burton outlines her role as a residents' group member. *"It's about relaying information to the Regeneration Project Team and from the Project Team to residents. It is also about having an input into how things could be and about getting the best out of the regeneration for everyone."*

If you are interested in joining the Resident Action Group please contact Linda Harris on 0208 320 3555.







ISSUE #4

editorial

Community Communication

Thamesmead is your community and it is important that you have a say in what happens in your neighbourhood. You know what the real issues are that impact on your daily lives. Only by telling us what affects you can we take steps to make changes. In this issue we have taken a look at the residents' groups and associations that are open to you.

All of them are designed to give your voice a platform to be heard. Our new patch teams will provide not only a focused approach to neighbourhood management but also a focal point of contact for residents. The structure is in place to create effective two-way communication - why not come along to one of our residents' meetings and see for yourself.

Thamesview is your magazine and it is important to us that we know your point of view. If you have something to say that other residents need to hear why not give the team at Thamesview a call on 0208 320 3414.

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Share your memories

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Building a neighbourhood for all

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Professional coaching in Thamesmead

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A quick round up of the latest news

Football Crazy

Crossway Park in Thamesmead was transformed into a sea of different colours over the Easter holidays as Charlton Athletic Football Club kicked off their annual children's coaching campaign.

With kids kitted out in team colours ranging from Paris St Germain to Arsenal, the two-week project drew together a host of local children. Working in partnership with Gallions Housing Association and Bexley's Areas of Opportunity, this is the second year Charlton have brought their professional coaching skills to Thamesmead.

Mums, dads and children all agree that it is a great way to spend the school holidays. Rachel Grant, a 26-year old mother of five, is particularly pleased with the community initiative. " Four of my children are on the course and it's a great way to keep them busy during the holidays. It's healthy, it's fun and it's free – which is particularly important for me with five to keep occupied."

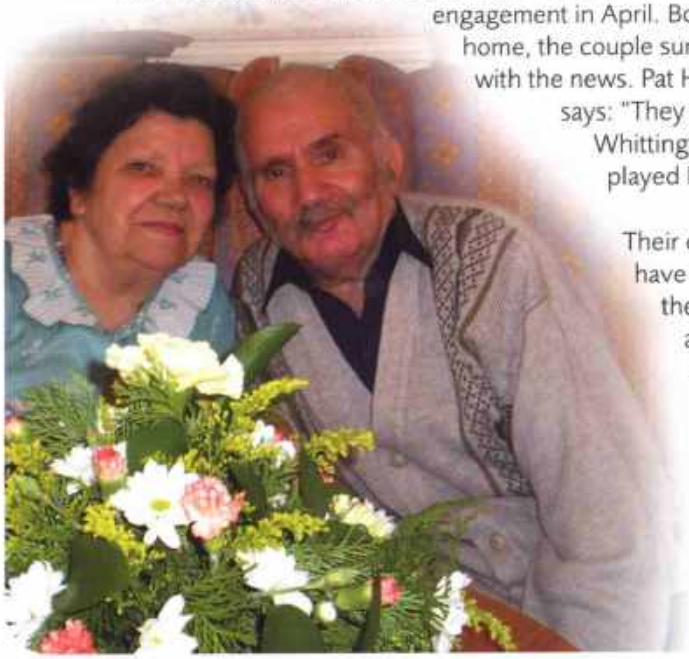
Miranda Gordon-Peiniger's 6-year old son Sam is so keen on his football that his mum signed him up on the course for both weeks. "Sam spends all his pocket money on football and has just bought the full Arsenal kit with his Easter money." Sam's enjoying himself so much that Miranda doesn't even mind standing on the sidelines every day.





Love is...

While the weather may not be exactly spring like, romance is most definitely in the air in Thamesmead. After a whirlwind 5-month courtship, Violet Barwick (85) and Ralph Jay (83) announced their engagement in April. Both residents of Marlborough House care home, the couple surprised and delighted their friends and family with the news. Pat Holttum, Manager of Marlborough House says: "They met during a Christmas production of Dick Whittington. Ralph played the lead role and Violet played Princess Alice.



Their characters got married at the end and they have been together ever since." Ralph knew from the start that Violet and he would be together and even told Pat to go out and "buy a Cilla Black hat." With 11 grandchildren and 8 great grandchildren between them the stage is certainly set for a big party when they do tie the knot.

When the announcement was made Pat and her team put together an impromptu engagement party to celebrate the good news.

Team Gallions

Here at Team Gallions we are committed to keeping Thamesmead as clean and tidy as possible. Our role includes removing graffiti, managing the parks and open spaces, cleaning the lifts and stairwells. Our rubbish amnesty is central to this commitment. People are calling us to take away their rubbish if they cannot get to the tip. However, people are also asking us to clear away entire gardens full of junk. We have even been asked to remove two halves of two different cars from one garage!

Our rubbish amnesty is limited to three items per household. So, if you need some help clearing large items from your home (or if you see rubbish discarded in the street) please book an appointment for us to come and collect it. Our next collection dates are: 7th and 9th of May and 4th and 6th June.

We also run an entirely free unwanted vehicle removal service where we can get asked to take away complete cars.

You must present the keys and log book at Gallions' reception together with proof of identity as the registered owner before we can remove the car.

Telephone 0800 83 84 81



THE cAve

HELLO! have you heard about the cAve? It's an indoor climbing wall where you can experience the excitement and challenges of rock climbing in a fun and safe environment all year round.

Interested?
We're open seven days a week and offer real value-for-money. You climb for as little as £3 an hour. It's your choice, you can climb as an individual, a family or part of group - we even do birthday parties!

When are we open?
16:00 to 19:00 (last climb 18:00) Mon-Fri
13:30 and 17:30 (last climb 16:30) Weekends.

Where are we?
The cAve is situated in a unique position, within an extensive archway beneath Harrow Manor Way in Thamesmead.

Want to know more?
T. 020 8320 4470 or 07866 741952
E. thecave@trust-thamesmead.co.uk
The cAve is operated by Trust Thamesmead
Arch 3 | Harrow Manor Way | Thamesmead | London | SE2 9XL



The Cave is owned and operated by Trust Thamesmead

points of view

There are quite a few community groups out there. Residents groups ensure the people of Thamesmead have a platform for their voice, support groups to provide help and advice or training groups for those who want to learn new skills. Wendy Mason outlines what's available and how you can get involved.



Neighbourhood Forums

These meetings are a joint initiative between Gallions and the Gallions Resident Board. It is your opportunity to express your views on how services are delivered in your area. You can raise any concerns you have about your neighbourhood and can make suggestions about how to change things. The neighbourhood forums are a means to help improve your quality of life. At these meetings you will meet Gallions representatives from the housing co-ordinators team, the community involvement team and Team Gallions. They are there to listen to you and to gain an insight into the issues that affect your daily life.

Have you experienced crime or anti-social behaviour in your area?

Then come along to the next neighbourhood forum and find out how you can get involved in tackling these concerns. If you have a specific item which you would like to discuss at a meeting please get in touch with us and let us know.

Resident Information Sessions



May sees the launch of a pilot scheme where we hold a series of meetings to discuss and explain any issues that you may need help with. The first session will cover two topics - Basics in Banking and Understanding your Rent Statement. Banking will include discussions about subjects such as using your chequebook and helping residents learn about the new chip and pin system. Designed to limit the risk of financial fraud, some residents are unsure about how the chip and pin system works.

Feedback has also shown us that a number of residents have found it difficult to understand their rent statements. Our information session will help clarify this. At the moment we are planning to run one session a day, but we may include an evening session if there is enough demand. Future information sessions will look at subjects including Pensions and Benefits. If you are interested in coming along please contact Wendy Mason.

Community Contact Schemes



We have introduced a community contact scheme for those areas which are not already represented by a Tenants and Residents Association. It is an opportunity to ensure your voice is heard. Working closely with representatives from Gallions, the community contact scheme will help highlight areas of concern and will identify problems in the neighbourhood.

Disabled Tenants and Residents Association

DATRA is a new association which works to improve conditions for people who are disabled or whose health is in any way impaired. It is an independent organisation run by disabled people for disabled people. We provide help, support and information on housing and environmental issues.
If you are interested in becoming a volunteer please call 01322 351081 or write to:
DATRA c/o 20 Whitehall Lane, Slade Green DA8 2DH

Victim Support

Victim support is a national charity that is run by fully trained volunteers. The services on offer are free and available to everyone including independent bodies, victims and witnesses alike. The Witness Service provides on-going assistance throughout the court procedure. Whether emotional support or practical help is needed – we can provide both. Gallions runs a drop-in centre every Wednesday morning in the Tenant Resource Centre. If you have been a witness or a victim of crime, don't suffer in silence.

For all enquiries please contact Wendy Mason on Tel: 0208 320 3417

Free Open Day

Spring into Action

At Gallions Resources Centre - Friday 27th May 2005 - 10am - 2pm

Harrow Manor Way, Thamesmead
Tel: 0208 320 3468 (Linda Thompson)
01322 552561 (Jas Dhillon)

Come and join us - free creche, free refreshment, free courses

DIY for beginners • container/patio gardening
hairstyling • drawing with pastels • relaxation/aromatherapy
languages and sign language • first aid • food hygiene
parchment craft • career advice and guidance • computing

Adult Education College Bexley

Take a walk with the Wardens



The Neighbourhood Wardens are a familiar sight around Thamesmead and play an important role in the community. We are aware of the issues that concern you and always looking at ways to address them. We have now launched a Neighbourhood Warden Drop in surgery at the Tavy Bridge Project Office. At the surgery we will be discussing such items as anti-social behaviour, environmental problems and youth diversionary activities. Everybody who lives in the area is welcome to come along and join in the discussions.

The Wardens do a lot of work with the young people of Thamesmead and have recently become involved with the Thamesmead Centre Youth Club. Located beside the Bexley Business Academy the club is attended by about 60 kids. Currently understaffed, the Wardens stepped into the breach and have now become a regular feature. Every week they bring along computer games and fortnightly they run their remote-controlled car club. The club is set to move in the next few months, and you can be certain that they will be welcome in their new premises.



Neighbourhood management update

Last year Gallions conducted an in-depth status survey together with two Best Value reviews. We wanted a complete overview of how you felt about your specific locality. Looking at all areas from safety and security to housing and maintenance, one thing became clear - residents wanted to get to know the people who were responsible for the management of their neighbourhood. What was also evident was that each patch within Thamesmead has its own set of unique challenges.

As a result we have created a number of patch teams, each consisting of five key contacts within Gallions, each responsible for a specific area within Thamesmead.

Each team comprises a housing co-ordinator, a neighbourhood warden, a building services representative, a member of Team Gallions and a revenue recovery officer. Individually, each team member will be on hand with help and advice in their own subject. Together they will offer residents a comprehensive problem solving solution to any difficulties they may have. Operational from May, this pilot scheme will be launched initially with two patch teams who will be responsible for Parkview and Broadwaters.

one to one

write up your street

Emma Turner, Marketing Manager at Gallions, tells us how the Thamesview team are out and about in the community finding out all those stories.

Wherever and whenever there's a community event or new scheme being launched you will find one of the team there to get the inside information to bring to the rest of the community.

"We always seem to be rushing from one story to another - there always something happening in Thamesmead - its such a busy community".

One wish would be that people were not so shy or humble about their achievements as there are so many great stories out there but sometimes understandably people are reluctant to let everyone know – but the team promise, however shy, they will be gentle with you!

Thamesview was introduced at the beginning of the year to coincide with a new marketing team who have all worked on magazines and newspapers before. The new team are really enjoying their work *"Its great as we really do get involved in lots of different projects from running the magazine and gathering stories to organising events - which means we get to meet just some of the faces who live and work in Thamesmead".*

With such a diverse group of people living in the town its definitely a challenge to try and reach everybody but the team do try to cover as many different types of story as they can, as well as bring you all the important updates from inside Gallions.

"Everything you need to know about services and changes in Gallions is in here, as well as meeting dates, future events and contact details. We've tried to cut down on all the separate information we send out to residents combining it all in one handy monthly magazine".

We really want people to get involved – there's lots of opportunities for guest reporter stories – such as joining our in-house team for a day to cover a story that's important to you and seeing it published.

Don't forget as well if you are a local business with a great offer for residents or a club that needs more members let us know and we can run your story.

So next time you are organising an event, know of work being done in the community or simply have some good news to share be sure to give the Thamesview team a call.

Please call Emma, Joy, Caroline or Steve on 020 8320 3414.



Caroline and Steve



Joy and Emma

Dates for your diary

Neighbourhood Forums - An opportunity to have your say on local community issues and to put your point to Gallions' representatives.

Broadwaters

25th May 10.30am – 12.30 pm, Village Hall

Wendy Mason
Tel: 0208 320 3417

Moorings

6th June 2.00pm – 4.00pm, Jubilee Hall

Parkview

15th June 10.00am – 12.00pm, Teeswater Atrium

Harrow Manor Way

23rd June 1.00pm – 3.00pm, Community Resource Centre

LEASEHOLDERS LINE

Remember, morning surgery drop in sessions are held on the first Thursday of every month 10am till 12pm. All other times need an appointment.

This is your last chance to nominate for the good neighbour award, final entry date is the 15th May 2005 so please call Joy Mckee on 020 8320 3414 with the name of your neighbour who deserves the award for all their help and kindness.

ASB HOTLINE

The anti social behaviour hotline gives you the opportunity to report disruptive or nuisance behaviour. It is an automated system and you will reach a recorded message asking for details of the problem. The hotline is monitored and your message will be forwarded to the appropriate authorities. Please note that our hotline is simply there to record the details of your complaint - it is not a responsive service and should not be used in an emergency situation. We want to stamp out anti-social behaviour and we need your help to do it.



News Review



Creative talent

This summer the undercroft in Tavy Bridge will be transformed into one big artist's easel. Gallions, in partnership with Axis, are bringing in a local community artist to paint out all the existing graffiti.

All young artists will then be invited to use the walls as a blank canvas to display their own creative talent. Not only will those involved learn some professional painting and decorating tips, but one of the artists will also be offered a painting and decorating apprenticeship with AXIS.

It's a great opportunity for one lucky person and it's sure to be a lot of fun for everyone. Watch out for more details nearer the time.

Under Occupancy Scheme

Are you eligible for our Under Occupancy Scheme? We have put together a package to help tenants who are living in properties too large for them move home. The package includes:

- Removal costs of up to £500
- A set amount of £200 for each surplus bedroom
- Disconnection and reconnection charges for utilities (where applicable)
- Cost of carpets up to £400

Reimbursements will be given on receipt of paid invoices.

For more information about what's available, contact Pam Pickett on 0208 320 3405.

Thamesmead in Bloom



Make sure you keep your entries coming in for the Thamesmead in Bloom competition. Whether you or your neighbour has a balcony, box or a garden full of bloom we want you to enter. The three winners (one from each category) will win a prize and if you nominate another garden and they win you too will get a prize. So what are you waiting for - spot those gardens and then get them entered.

Forms are available from Team Gallions or the marketing team.

Apology

An article published in the spring edition of the GRB Voice (number 9) was incorrect.

We stated that Gallions Housing Association was still to start work on a promised rewiring programme for Wolvercote Road. The correct position is that rewiring work has been completed in the town houses and two tower blocks, Clewer and Wyfold. Radley and Hybernian are scheduled for this financial year (2005/6) while Maplin and Duxford are planned for 2006/7.

We apologise for any confusion this error may have caused.

Gallions' Resident Board

GRB
GALLIONS RESIDENTS' BOARD



GALLIONS FREEPHONE 0800 83 84 81

A helping hand to kick the habit



Anyone who has ever tried to stop smoking knows how difficult it can be. That's why Greenwich Primary Care Trust in partnership with Neighbourhood Renewal Greenwich are spearheading a drive to increase the number of community based stop smoking support groups and venues.

"We have over 150 advisors, all over the borough, who deliver individual support. We also run a specialist midwife support group for pregnant smokers and we do home visits to support smokers who are house-bound. We are trying to make stopping smoking easier by bringing the support network closer to home by setting up group sessions at local and convenient venues." enthused Isaac Ojo, Smoking Cessation Service Manager

Are you a community group, residents association or a local business that wants to start a local quit smoking group or can provide premises? Do you want to find out more about the services available or how to access them? Then please call the smoking cessation service on 0207 737 2213 and ask for Adetayo Idowu or 0208 694 7328 and ask for Isaac Ojo.

A new stop smoking group has been set up in the Gallions Reach Health Centre in Bentham Road, Thamesmead. Starting on Wednesday 19th May, 1.00pm to 2.00pm, the session will run for six weeks.

ਜੇ ਅੰਗਰੇਜ਼ੀ ਤੁਹਾਡੀ ਪਹਿਲੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਨਹੀਂ, ਅਤੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਦਸਤਾਵੇਜ਼ ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ, ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਆਪਣੀ ਚੁਣੀ ਹੋਈ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਦੇ ਨਾਂ ਦੇ ਨੇੜੇ ਵਾਲੇ ਖ਼ਾਨੇ ਵਿਚ ਸਹੀ ਦਾ ਨਿਸ਼ਾਨ ਲਾ ਕੇ, ਅਤੇ ਦੱਸੀ ਹੋਈ ਥਾਂ 'ਤੇ ਆਪਣਾ ਨਾਂ ਅਤੇ ਪਤਾ ਲਿਖ ਕੇ ਇਹ ਫ਼ਾਰਮ ਕਿਸੇ ਲਿਫ਼ਾਫ਼ੇ ਵਿਚ ਪਾ ਕੇ ਹੇਠ ਲਿਖੇ ਪਤੇ 'ਤੇ ਭੇਜ ਦਿਓ।

如果英語不是您的母語，您希望將該文件翻譯出來的話，請在您選擇的語言旁邊打勾。請在所示之處填上您的姓名和地址，併用信封將本表格寄到下列地址。

Nếu Anh ngữ không phải là ngôn ngữ chính, Quý vị muốn dịch tài liệu này, xin vui lòng đánh dấu vào ô kế bên ngôn ngữ Quý vị chọn, ghi tên và địa chỉ vào nơi chỉ dẫn và gởi mẫu vào phòng bì theo địa chỉ dưới đây.

PUNJABI ☐ **CHINESE** ☐ **VIETNAMESE** ☐

(please tick one)

Name: _____

Address: _____

_____

_____

Return to: Joy McKee, Translation Requests, Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London SE2 9XH

Contact us

Gallions Housing Association
Harrow Manor Way
London
SE2 9XH

For all enquiries please contact the
Customer Response Centre
0800 83 84 81
It's a freephone number that you can use to book services, repairs or for any other enquiries.

GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION